



General Assembly

February Session, 2026

Raised Bill No. 235

LCO No. 1512



Referred to Committee on TRANSPORTATION

Introduced by:
(TRA)

AN ACT CONCERNING DRIVER EDUCATION AND STUDENT SAFETY.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. Section 14-78 of the general statutes is repealed and the
2 following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October 1, 2026*):

3 (a) A drivers' school licensee shall permit a student to choose the
4 gender of such student's instructor prior to the commencement of
5 behind-the-wheel instruction, except if only one gender of instructors is
6 available to provide such instruction at the drivers' school, such licensee
7 shall notify a prospective student of the availability of only one gender
8 of instructors prior to such prospective student enrolling in a course of
9 behind-the-wheel instruction.

10 (b) Not later than October 1, 2027, a drivers' school licensee shall
11 equip each vehicle used to provide behind-the-wheel instruction with
12 an (1) electronic monitoring system, such as a global positioning system,
13 to ensure the location of a student is ascertainable during a course of
14 behind-the-wheel instruction, and (2) an audio or video monitoring
15 system to ensure the safety of a student during such instruction.

16 (c) The commissioner may adopt regulations, in accordance with the
 17 provisions of chapter 54, regarding the conduct of drivers' schools and
 18 instructor license requirements. Such regulations shall (1) establish the
 19 conduct of drivers' schools, including, but not limited to, (A)
 20 requirements as to the inspection of the vehicles used by the drivers'
 21 schools in the conduct of their business, (B) instructional standards and
 22 procedures, including instruction of not less than fifteen minutes
 23 concerning the responsibilities of an operator of a motor vehicle under
 24 subsection (b) of section 14-223 and the penalty for a violation of the
 25 provisions of said subsection, instruction concerning highway work
 26 zone safety and the responsibilities of an operator of a motor vehicle
 27 under section 14-212d, [and] instruction concerning ways to reduce
 28 incidents of operators driving in the wrong direction and actions to take
 29 when an operator encounters a motor vehicle being operated in the
 30 wrong direction, and behind-the-wheel instruction and practice
 31 concerning how to stop in a safe location off the traveled portion of the
 32 highway and respond to a traffic stop by a law enforcement officer, (C)
 33 the administration of a test at the conclusion of each class, (D) the
 34 posting of rates charged for instruction, and (E) the general form in
 35 which records concerning persons under instruction and those who
 36 have completed their course of instruction shall be kept and, when
 37 required, the method of transmission to the commissioner, (2) except as
 38 required pursuant to section 14-36j, permit a class or classroom
 39 instruction to be offered in person in a congregate setting, through
 40 distance learning or through a combination of both in-person and
 41 distance learning, provided such distance learning has interactive
 42 components such as mandatory interactions, participation or testing,
 43 and (3) establish the requirements for a person to receive a license as an
 44 instructor in accordance with section 14-73.

45 (d) On and after October 1, 2010, the commissioner shall not issue a
 46 license that is limited to classroom instruction. Any person who was
 47 issued such limited license prior to October 1, 2010, may maintain and
 48 renew such license.

49 Sec. 2. Section 14-36f of the general statutes is repealed and the
50 following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October 1, 2026*):

51 The Commissioner of Motor Vehicles shall adopt regulations, in
52 accordance with the provisions of chapter 54, governing the
53 establishment, conduct and scope of driver education programs in
54 secondary schools of this state, subject to the requirements of section 14-
55 36e. Such regulations shall (1) permit any local or regional board of
56 education or private secondary school to contract with a licensed
57 drivers' school approved by the Commissioner of Motor Vehicles for the
58 behind-the-wheel instruction of such driver education program and
59 instruction therein may be given by such school's driving instructors
60 who are licensed by the Department of Motor Vehicles, (2) require that
61 the classroom instruction of any such driver education program include
62 (A) a discussion concerning highway work zone safety and the
63 responsibilities of an operator of a motor vehicle under section 14-212d,
64 and (B) a discussion concerning ways to reduce incidents of operators
65 driving in the wrong direction and actions to take when an operator
66 encounters a motor vehicle being operated in the wrong direction, [and]
67 (3) except for instruction offered pursuant to section 14-36j, permit a
68 class or classroom instruction to be offered in person in a congregate
69 setting, through distance learning or through a combination of both in-
70 person and distance learning, provided such distance learning has
71 interactive components such as mandatory interactions, participation or
72 testing, and (4) require that the behind-the-wheel instruction of any such
73 driver education program include instruction and practice regarding
74 how to stop in a safe location off the traveled portion of the highway
75 and respond to a traffic stop by a law enforcement officer.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:

Section 1	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	14-78
Sec. 2	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	14-36f

Statement of Purpose:

To (1) permit a student to choose the gender of such student's driving instructor prior to behind-the-wheel instruction, (2) require vehicles used by a drivers' school to be equipped with an electronic monitoring system and an audio or video monitoring system, and (3) provide behind-the-wheel instruction in how to respond to a traffic stop by a law enforcement officer.

[Proposed deletions are enclosed in brackets. Proposed additions are indicated by underline, except that when the entire text of a bill or resolution or a section of a bill or resolution is new, it is not underlined.]